Daily Content Intel

July 30, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, so a new study out of Dublin City University put 15 female team sport athletes through a simulated 90 minute match twice. Once after 2 days of eating 6 grams of carbohydrate per kilogram of body weight, and once after 2 days at 3 grams.

Same calories both times. The only thing that changed was the carbohydrate.

Time to exhaustion at the end came out basically identical, so if that's all you measured, you'd say the diet did nothing.

The sprint numbers inside the test are where it shows up. In blocks 3, 4 and 5, so roughly the second half, the high carbohydrate athletes were sprinting faster, and their perceived exertion was lower back in the first half, which means the same work felt easier earlier on.

Then the part I care about most. Reaction time on a task switching test got better from pre to post exercise in the high carbohydrate group, and it didn't budge in the moderate group. Fatigue was eating their decision making, and food changed it.

For a 175 pound athlete, 6 grams per kilo is about 475 grams of carbohydrate a day. That's a real number, and most of the high school athletes I see are nowhere near it on a Thursday or a Friday.

This was 15 players, so treat that number as a starting point and adjust from there.

Monday's move is simple. The 2 days before a game, carbs go up, protein stays where it is.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: The last 15 minutes of your game got decided by what you ate 2 days ago.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, so a new study out of Dublin City University put 15 female team sport athletes through a simulated 90 minute match twice. Once after 2 days of eating 6 grams of carbohydrate per kilogram of body weight, and once after 2 days at 3 grams.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 What you ate Thursday shows up in the 4th quarter

- 0:08 6 g/kg vs 3 g/kg carbohydrate. 2 days. Same calories.
- 0:20 Time to exhaustion: no difference
- 0:30 Sprint times: faster in blocks 3, 4 and 5
- 0:42 Reaction time improved only on high carbs
- 0:55 175 lb athlete = roughly 475 g carbs/day
- 1:10 Thursday and Friday are the game plan
- 1:20 Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Two days out from a game, the carbohydrate number matters more than most athletes think.

New study out of Dublin City University. 15 female team sport athletes ran a simulated match twice: once after 2 days at 6 g/kg of carbohydrate, once after 2 days at 3 g/kg, calories matched both times.

Time to exhaustion was the same. Sprint times in blocks 3, 4 and 5 were faster on the high carbohydrate diet. Perceived exertion was lower early. Reaction time on a task switching test improved after exercise only in the high carbohydrate group.

For a 175 pound athlete, 6 g/kg is around 475 grams of carbohydrate a day. Most of the high school athletes I work with are nowhere close on a Thursday or Friday.

Fuel Thursday and Friday for a Saturday game and you get 2 things back: speed late, and cleaner decisions late.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
threshold.clientsecure.me

#footballtraining #lacrosse #highschoolfootball #sportsnutrition #athletedevelopment #strengthandconditioning #fueltoperform #performancenutrition #novafootball #collegiateathlete

Personalize this

- Which of your HS football or club lacrosse athletes has a visible 4th-quarter or 4th-quarter-equivalent drop off, and what does their Thursday and Friday eating actually look like when you ask them directly?
- You program HS football in-season. What's the fueling conversation you have on a Thursday lift day, and would you change it to a carbohydrate target in grams instead of "eat more"?
- The reaction-time finding is a decision-making story. Name a game or practice where you watched an athlete's mental errors climb in the second half. Does that read as conditioning, or as fuel, and how would you tell the difference?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42521197/ | "Comparison of 2 Days of Moderate or High Carbohydrate Intake on Physical and Cognitive Performance in Female Team Sport Players During a Simulated Soccer Match Protocol"

- physiology | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42521197/ | "Sprint times were faster during HIGH compared with MOD at Block 3"
- actionable | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42521197/ | "female soccer players may benefit from increasing daily CHO intake to at least 6 g/kg BM for the 2 days preceding competitive matches"

Sources:

- https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42521197/
- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10515665/

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. Your team's hamstring standard is one number on a wall, and that number is wrong for half your roster.

New paper in the Journal of Strength and Conditioning Research measured eccentric hamstring strength in 332 Division 1 football players across 4 teams, then normalized it to body weight.

Skill guys, power guys and special teams all came out significantly stronger than the linemen. Same sport, same weight room, different job, different number. So when you hang one team-wide hamstring benchmark, your linemen are chasing a standard built off a corner's body.

The part that should sting is the follow up. They tracked 50 of those athletes across 3 seasons. Normalized strength didn't change. The p value was 0.89. Three years of college strength and conditioning, and relative eccentric hamstring strength stayed flat.

And it lines up with the youth data, where normalized Nordic strength sits around 4.7 newtons per kilo from about age 13 all the way through 18. It plateaus and then it just sits there.

Time in a weight room and eccentric hamstring training are 2 different things.

So, position specific standards. Side to side comparison on every athlete. And eccentric loading that lives on the calendar year round, in-season included, instead of showing up in June and disappearing in August.

Does that make sense?

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: 3 full seasons in a college weight room, and their hamstrings were exactly as strong as when they walked in.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. Your team's hamstring standard is one number on a wall, and that number is wrong for half your roster.

New paper in the Journal of Strength and Conditioning Research measured eccentric hamstring strength in 332 Division 1 football players across 4 teams, then normalized it to body weight.

Skill guys, power guys and special teams all came out significantly stronger than the linemen. Same sport, same weight room, different job, different number. So when you hang one team-wide hamstring benchmark, your linemen are chasing a standard built off a corner's body.

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And it lines up with the youth data, where normalized Nordic strength sits around 4.7 newtons per kilo from about age 13 all the way through 18. It plateaus and then it just sits there.

Time in a weight room and eccentric hamstring training are 2 different things.

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Does that make sense?

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 3 seasons. Zero change.
- 0:07 332 D1 football players, 4 teams
- 0:16 Skill, power and special teams > linemen ($p < 0.001$)

- 0:28 One benchmark for the whole roster is a bad benchmark
- 0:40 50 athletes tracked 3 seasons: $p = 0.89$
- 0:55 Youth Nordic strength plateaus at ~4.7 N/kg after 13
- 1:08 Position standards. Side to side. Year round.
- 1:20 Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Position-specific hamstring standards, or your linemen are failing a test that was never built for them.

New paper in the Journal of Strength and Conditioning Research. 332 NCAA Division 1 football players across 4 teams, eccentric hamstring strength normalized to body mass. Skill, power and special teams athletes were significantly stronger than linemen.

Then the follow up: 50 of those athletes tracked across 3 seasons, and normalized strength did not change. The p value was 0.89.

Youth data says the same thing from the other end. Normalized Nordic strength sits around 4.7 N/kg from age 13 through 18 unless somebody actually trains it.

Time in a weight room and eccentric hamstring training are 2 different things.

What I use: position-specific benchmarks, side to side comparison on every athlete, and eccentric hamstring loading that stays on the calendar through the season.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#footballtraining #hamstring #strengthandconditioning #highschoolfootball #lacrosse #athletedevelopment #injuryprevention #returntosport #sportsPT #novafootball

Personalize this

- In the HS football programs you build, what does a lineman's hamstring work look like next to a skill player's, and are you already splitting the standard or holding everyone to one number?

- You've made return-to-sport calls on hamstring athletes. What did you use for the side-to-side call without a NordBord, and how would you explain that test to a HS coach in 30 seconds?
- The flat 3-season result is an in-season programming indictment. What's your actual in-season eccentric dose for football, and where does it fit in a Monday-through-Friday game week?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42506958/ | "Normalized Eccentric Hamstring Strength in Collegiate American Football: Position-Based Norms and Longitudinal Patterns"
- physiology | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42506958/ | "skill, power, and special teams athletes had significantly greater normalized strength than linemen"
- actionable | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42506958/ | "using position-specific benchmarks to

guide individualized training, rehabilitation, and return-to-play strategies"

Sources:

- https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42506958/
- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10588571/

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Timing-gate placement changes sprint force-velocity metrics (Sensors, 7/22, PMID 42515524): 3 gates over a shorter distance gives you the same numbers as the full setup. Good hot take on speed-testing theater and on cheap testing for HS programs.
- Preoperative mood disorders and postoperative complications in adolescent sports injuries (Sports Health, 7/23, PMID 42494097): psychological lens on return-to-sport, pairs with the 7/24 readiness-profile piece.
- Longitudinal seasonal development in youth trained soccer players (Sports, 7/20, PMID 42506851): what actually improves and what quietly regresses across a competitive season.

Sources scanned today

- **Newsletter digest** (newsletter_digest_2026-07-30.pdf): thin day. 1 source processed (Dr. Mercola), 0 educational links. Everything usable was promo (curcumin, NAC/milk thistle) plus one teaser on muscle circadian clocks and strength loss with no linked study and no athlete relevance. Nothing pulled forward.

- **PubMed, date-filtered 2026-07-20 to 2026-07-31** (athlete/football/lacrosse × sprint/hamstring/return-to-sport/change-of-direction/plyometric): 13 hits. Best of the set: normalized eccentric hamstring strength norms in Division 1 football (J Strength Cond Res, 7/27), 2 days of moderate vs high carbohydrate before a simulated match (IJSNEM, 7/28), timing-gate placement and force-velocity metrics (Sensors, 7/22), longitudinal seasonal performance in youth soccer (Sports, 7/20), plyometrics in adolescent sport meta-analysis (PeerJ, 7/23).
- **PubMed, date-filtered 2026-07-15 to 2026-07-31** (youth/HS/collegiate × sleep/protein/nutrition/recovery/creatine/energy availability): 7 hits, mostly concussion knowledge and behavioral health in pediatric ortho. Preoperative mood

disorders and postoperative complications in adolescent sports injuries (Sports Health, 7/23) held as a runner-up.

- **Web search**: HS football in-season sprint development (SimpliFaster, TrainHeroic, an 8-week plyometric RCT registration NCT07640958), carbohydrate loading and team-sport sprint output (GSSI, JISSN 2023), eccentric hamstring normative data by age (youth Nordic normative paper).
- Podcast show notes (Pacey, Just Fly, Iron Culture), NSCA blog, and Reddit r/AdvancedFitness were not reachable inside this run's search returns. Skipped, noted here.
- Deduped against `cited-sources.json` (106 entries). Plyometrics (7/16) and the two prior hamstring days (7/28, 7/29) were checked; today's hamstring source is a different paper and a fresh URL. All 4 URLs below are clean.